

LAKSHMI ARUNA

A Motherly Leader in Blazing Ballari!

"He was like my son, too."

When Lakshmi Aruna, wife of BJP leader Gali Janardana Reddy, spoke these words to a mother who had lost her son to mob violence, the moment transcended politics.

As she handed over a ₹10 lakh personal cheque on behalf the BJP and offered a comforting embrace, it marked the emergence of a "motherly leader" in the often-volatile political landscape of Ballari.

The circumstances were remarkable: the boy belonged to the very mob she accused of attempting to kill her husband. Even knowing he was a Congress worker, Lakshmi remained undeterred. To her, all that mattered was a mother's grief. She was compelled by empathy to reach out and console.

Yet, this sentimental side is only half of the story. Her "warrior face" unraveled later that day. Speaking at a BJP rally protesting the January 1st attack on Janardana Reddy's home by followers of MLA Bharath Reddy, she was fearless. "The whole world knows that the mayhem was a clear attempt on my husband Janardana Reddy's life," she declared, demanding a thorough CBI probe. She argued that the state's CID investigation was merely an attempt to protect the perpetrators.

Political circles now agree: Lakshmi Aruna has truly arrived.

While she is a new face in active politics—having first contested the Ballari City seat in the last Assembly elections—she is no stranger to the region's pulse. For decades, she worked away from the public glare, dedicating herself to the aged, the needy, and orphans at Vishwabharathi Kalanikethan Society, a charity organization established by her husband Janardana Reddy.



Her growth since that election loss has been immense. Following the January 1st attack, she did not react with grief or shock. Instead, she surrendered to faith, climbing 512 steps barefoot to Bhagawan Anjaneya's Anjanadri Hill at dawn to pray and seek strength. Upon her return, she became a source of calm and stability to thousands of BJP workers who poured in from all over the state to express their solidarity. She personally supervised arrangements for their stay and meals for more than 15 days, ensuring their spirits remained steady and their focus remained calm during a period of high tension.

Her journey is a transformative one: born into a farming family in a small Andhra Pradesh village, she moved to Ballari, mastered the language, and navigated years of personal and political trauma.

Today, the party cadre sees her as an inspirational leader who blends faith with fortitude and empathy with execution.

Lakshmi Aruna Janardana Reddy's journey is no longer just about standing beside a leader—it is about becoming one.

